BUSINESS PLAN · VERSION 3 · REWRITTEN

# Algorithmic futures trading plan

Automated NQ / ES strategies traded through Apex prop-firm accounts, funding a personal account later. This version is rewritten from scratch with the plan agreed on October 30 and an honest look at the first three weeks live.

| Date | Previous | Markets | Platform |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| **October 30, 2026** | **v2 Oct 24 · v1 Oct 16** | **MNQ · MES · MCL** | **MultiCharts · Rithmic · VPS** |

All performance figures are backtests (2018–2026) and simulations on real market history, after costs. They are not guarantees. The plan assumes live results reach about 75% of the backtest; the first live weeks are below that, on too few trades to judge yet (section 2).

1 · AT A GLANCE

# The short version

Use Apex evaluations as a cheap way to get funded capital for a set of tested, automated strategies; turn payouts into more accounts, and later into a personal account with no payout cap.

| LIVE ACCOUNTS | LIVE TRADES | FUNDED BY DEC 31 | 2027 FROM APEX |
|---|---|---|---|
| **1 of 3** | **23 · −$6.2k** | **~3–6** | **~$100k** |
| #1 (50K) and #3 (150K) failed; #2 (50K) live, $1,064 above its floor | Gross, all accounts since 10/12. Too few trades to judge the edge | Typical, 150Ks bought from job pay (75% edge / full backtest) | Typical at 75% of the edge; ~$175k if the job continues* |

**The honest picture**

The strategies are well tested on 2018–2026 data, but nothing is proven live yet. Two of three evaluations failed, both on one ordinary full stop at a thin cushion, which happens in about half of all evaluations even in the backtest. The bigger risk in the plan is timing: in 13–31% of simulated histories, a bad November–December fails every evaluation and nothing is funded by year end.

## What we decided on October 30

### Accounts

- No more new 50Ks. #2 runs to its end.
- Every new account is a **150K No-Activation** ($249, no activation fee).
- Replace #3 with #4 on Sunday Nov 1 (catches the Sunday-evening Bridge trade).
- From Nov 13: all job pay goes to 150Ks, **one purchase a day**, never several the same day.

### Trading rules

- Full size always: skipping or shrinking trades on a thin cushion tested worse.
- Stop buying if the drift alarm fires (live clearly below backtest).
- Mid-December gate: 40–70 live trades at ≥75% of backtest before scaling further.
- Personal account opens once Apex pays for its own replacements (~March with the job).

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2 · WHERE WE STAND

# Live results, honestly

Live since October 12 on a QuantVPS in Chicago (MultiCharts + Rithmic, data from dxFeed).
Three evaluations so far.

| ACCOUNT | TYPE | STARTED | STATUS | WHAT HAPPENED |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **#1** APEX-681524-01 | 50K | Oct 12 | Failed 10/26 | One Vault Break stop with ~$400 of room left |
| **#2** APEX-681524-02 | 50K | Oct 20 | Live · thin | ~$49,828, $1,064 above the floor (less than one full stop); model odds to pass from here ~46% |
| **#3** APEX-681524-03 | 150K No-Activation | Oct 26 | Failed 10/30 | Overnight Bias short (normal −115 pt loss) touched the floor intraday; Apex liquidated it |

VAULT BREAK, PER TRADE

**−11 pts**

9 live signals vs +5 pts in the backtest. One standard error is ~17 pts: not yet meaningful

DRIFT ALARM

**Not triggered**

CUSUM 1.8 vs alarm at 25 (Vault Break). The alarm is built to catch a real decay early

STOP SLIPPAGE

**1.8 ticks**

Vault Break stops fill ~1.8 ticks worse vs 1 assumed (9 fills); targets fill 1.5 ticks better

## What went wrong, and what it cost

| DATE | PROBLEM | COST | FIXED BY |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10/16–10/20 | Orders rejected: wrong symbol mapping (@MNQ instead of MNQZ6) | Missed trades | Symbol mapping + pre-flight checklist |
| 10/26 | #3's copied charts kept #2's account: 150K-size orders hit #2 | #2 briefly held 28 MNQ | Account check on every strategy after copying |
| 10/27 | Overnight Bias failed to compile while the chart looked normal; a +135 pt trade was missed | **~$1.1k on #2, ~$3.2k on #3** | Strategy heartbeat + missed-trade alarm |
| 10/30 | Apex flattened #3 without telling MultiCharts; ~100 exit orders rejected in a second | None (account already failed) | Rejected-orders limit 10; reset rule documented |

**The expensive one was operational, not the strategy**

The missed 10/27 trade would have put ~$3,240 into #3. With that cushion, today's loss would very likely not have failed it. The monitoring built since then (below) is there to stop that class of mistake.

## Live guard now in place

Phone alarms every 5 minutes in trading hours (MultiCharts down, no data, frozen chart, auto-trading off, strategy not running, position mismatch, rejected orders) · 08:21 pre-market check · trades pushed every 30 min · journal and live dashboard at 16:40 · Friday review with a Codex cross-check.

# What each account trades

Every strategy is automated in MultiCharts, flat by 15:59 CT for Apex. Tiers come from the tier list (S best, then A, B). Costs: $7.25 per NQ plus 1 tick per market or stop fill. 2 strategies are your designs, 7 come from our own forced-flow research (the plan's low-correlation core), the rest from code you found.

| STRATEGY | IDEA | TIER | ORIGIN | USED IN |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Vault Break** | Breakout above the midnight open + 30% ATR and VWAP; fixed target and stop | A | Your design | Evaluation · funded |
| **Overnight Bias** (ADX30 / ML) | 08:30 open's place in the overnight range sets the side; opening-range break | A / S | Your design | Evaluation · funded |
| **Expiration Open Short** | Short the open on monthly options expiration (dealer hedges unwind) | A | Our research | Evaluation · funded |
| **Bridge Monday Long** | Sunday evening to Monday close in an up-trend | A | Outside (The Bridge) | Evaluation · funded |
| **Late-Day Flow** | Follow big moves at 14:00 CT (leveraged-ETF rebalancing) | A | Our research | Funded |
| **Monday Long** | Long Mondays 08:30–15:00 (weekend inflows) | A | Our research | 150K funded · personal |
| **NFP Fade** | Fade the first payroll-report reaction | B | Our research | Funded |
| **ES MOC Follow** | Follow the pre-close move into the closing auction | B | Our research | Funded |
| **CL Sunday gap fade** | Fade crude oil's Sunday up-gap | A | Our research | Funded |
| **Overnight Tick / VIX** | Overnight long after a down day, order-flow × VIX filter | A | Outside | Funded |
| **Swing Target v3** | Break of the prior 2-day level, small target, break-even | B | Outside | Funded |
| **T_ONESIDE fade** | Night-volume switch fade | B | Outside | 50K funded |
| **Relative Strength** | NQ's 09:00 move beyond its ES beta | B | Outside | 150K funded · personal |
| Personal only | Twin Continuation (A), Dual Thrust v4 (A), PAPERTREND v2 (B); forward log first: FC 2B (A), Kusho v9, S47 v2, S30 IBS (B) | | | |

## Sizes by plan

| PLAN | WHAT RUNS | BACKTEST RESULT |
|---|---|---|
| **Evaluation** (50K) | Vault Break 8 MNQ · Overnight Bias $1,100 risk · Expiration Short $500 · Bridge 2 MNQ | Pass 50% |
| **Evaluation** (150K) | The same × 2.5 (VB 20, ONB $2,750, EOS $1,250, Bridge 5) | Pass ~40% |
| **50K funded** | 11 pieces: VB 1/1 + Swing Target 1, ONB ML $400, EOS, Late-Day Flow 2, NFP, ES MOC, CL fade, Bridge 1, Overnight Tick 1, T_ONESIDE 1 | ~$10.2k yr 1 · $12.3k / 2 yrs |
| **150K funded** | The 50K plan × 1.5 + Relative Strength 1 + Overnight Tick 2 + Swing Target 2 (+ Monday Long) | ~$18.1k yr 1 · $20.3k / 2 yrs |
| **Personal** | 19 pieces at 1 micro each | ~$41.5k / yr, needs ~$36k |

4 · EVIDENCE STANDARD

# How a strategy earns its place

Most ideas fail. The process is built to reject lucky backtests before they reach an account.

| IDEAS TESTED | BAR FOR A NEW ONE | THIS WEEK | HOLDOUT |
|---|---|---|---|
| **348** | **t ≥ 3.63** | **0 of ~20** | **2023–26** |
| Ranked S–F in the tier list; every test counts | Rises with each test (multiple-testing correction) | Papers, scouted papers, CHoCH, Prior VWAP Trap: none added | Kept unopened until a rule passes on 2018–22 |

## The pipeline

| STEP | WHAT HAPPENS |
|---|---|
| **1 · Write the rule first** | Rules and pass/fail gates are written down before results (pre-registration); no tuning after a failure |
| **2 · Backtest honestly** | 1-minute data 2018–2026, full costs, longs and shorts separately, by year, placebo controls |
| **3 · Independent check** | A separate checker rebuilds the rule from its written spec; MultiCharts must reproduce the trades |
| **4 · Add or replace** | Tested on the account simulators as an addition and as a replacement; kept only if it helps the plan |
| **5 · Live** | Apex incubation, compared trade by trade with the backtest (drift alarm), then the personal account |

**Why live will be lower than the backtest**

The plan's strategies were chosen on the same 2018–26 data they're scored on, and published market effects lose about a quarter of their returns out of sample (more after publication). The plan is sized to work at 75% of the backtest; every projection below shows both.

## Research engine

### Sources

- Your uploads (code, PDFs, papers)
- Paper scout: searches arXiv / NBER / SSRN, on demand ("scout") and Mon/Wed/Fri
- Codex: a second AI builder with its own tests, cross-checked weekly

### Records

- Tier list (every idea ranked)
- Execution references E01–E29 (fills, slippage, market behaviour)
- Pitfall log and lessons (mistakes not to repeat)

5 · FUNDING MODEL

# Apex: why 150K accounts

An evaluation is a paid test: reach the profit target without touching the trailing floor. Passing gives a funded account that pays out in capped steps, then closes.

| | 50K EVALUATION | 150K NO-ACTIVATION |
|---|---|---|
| Price | ~$59 + $130 activation on a pass | $249, no activation |
| Target / trailing floor | +$3,000 / $2,000 | +$9,000 / $4,000 |
| Pass rate (backtest) | ~50% | ~40% |
| Funded payouts, year 1 / 2 years | ~$10.2k / $12.3k | ~$18.1k / $20.3k |
| Funded account blown | ~5% | ~1% |
| Cost per funded account | ~$250 | ~$600 |

Apex caps you at about **20 accounts**, so account slots run out before money does. Each 150K slot earns ~65% more and rarely blows once funded, which is why every new account is a 150K.

## Thin cushions: tested twice, keep full size

| RULE WHEN THE CUSHION IS THIN | 50K: LOSSES PER PASS | 150K: LOSSES PER PASS |
|---|---|---|
| **Trade everything at full size (now)** | **1.00** | **1.40** |
| Overnight Bias off below one stop | 1.14 | 1.67 |
| Overnight Bias risk ≤ 50% of the cushion | 1.08 | 1.74 |
| Overnight Bias + Vault Break off | 1.76 | 2.89 |
| Vault Break cut to 4 (tested 10/26) | 0.95–1.02 (no gain) | — |

Losses = failed + unfinished evaluations (an unfinished one costs a new fee). Skipping trades lowers failures but the account stalls and runs out of days.

**Read a failed evaluation correctly**

About half of all evaluations fail even in the backtest. Two failures out of three happens about 40% of the time at these rates. Judge the strategies on live trades vs backtest, not on accounts lost.

6 · THE PLAN

# November–December, and 2027

Starting budget: zero. A job (Nov 10 – Dec 24, $25 × 8 h, paid weekly) funds evaluations; payouts take over from early 2027.

## Buying plan

| WHEN | PAY (AFTER TAX, EST.) | BUY |
|---|---|---|
| Sun Nov 1 | savings | #4 (150K): 4 charts, new account number in every strategy |
| Fridays Nov 13, 20, 27, Dec 4, 11, 18 | ~$850 (5 days) – $1,020 (6 days) | 3–4 × 150K per week, **one a day** |
| ~Dec 24 (last pay) | ~$500–700 | 2 × 150K, starting in January |
| From January | payouts (+ job if kept*) | Refill slots up to ~20 |

Why one a day: all accounts trade the same signals, so evaluations started on the same day pass or fail together. Spreading buys lowers the chance that nothing passes.

# Projections

Budget simulation: every paycheck and every payout buys 150K evaluations (up to 20 open), tested on every start day 2018–23 in real day order.

| SCENARIO | EVALUATIONS BY DEC 31 | FUNDED DEC 31 BAD · TYPICAL · GOOD | NOTHING FUNDED BY DEC 31 | FIRST PAYOUT | 2027 PAYOUTS BAD · TYPICAL · GOOD |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Job ends · full edge | 23–28 | 0 · 7–8 · 15–17 | 13–14% | late Feb | $0 · $252–264k · $403–410k |
| Job kept* · full edge | 23–28 | 0 · 6–8 · 14–17 | 13–14% | early Mar | $8k · $321–329k · $415k |
| **Job ends · 75% edge** | 23–28 | 0 · 3–4 · 12–14 | 29–31% | late Mar | **$0 · $89–116k · $289–315k** |
| **Job kept* · 75% edge** | 23–28 | 0 · 3–4 · 12–14 | 29–31% | late Mar | **$0 · $176–182k · $321–326k** |

Ranges cover 5 vs 6 workdays a week. Funded payouts are modelled with the October plan, ~15% below the current 150K plan, so payouts lean low. #2 (50K) is not included: a bonus if it passes.

PLAN ON (75% EDGE)

**~$100k**

2027 from Apex if the job ends Dec 24

WITH THE JOB*

**~$175k**

From Apex; ~$220k all-in with ~$44k of pay after tax

BAD CASE

**$0**

If nothing passes by year end and the money is gone

**Why a slow start, then a lot**

A funded 150K needs +$6,600 and five $350+ days before its first payout: that takes ~2½–3½ months. After that, payouts arrive every few weeks until the account's ~$20.5k is paid. So January–February bring little or no trading income; March–December bring most of 2027.

* Assumes the job ($25/h, 8 h, 5–6 days a week, ~$850–1,020 a week after tax) continues through 2027; pay goes to evaluations until Apex reaches ~20 accounts (~February), then to the personal account. Backtest-based; the live edge is not yet confirmed.

7 · PERSONAL ACCOUNT

# Apex first, personal second

$249 in an evaluation that passes earns ~$14–20k; $249 in a personal account earns ~$200 a year. So money goes to Apex until it is at its account cap and pays for its own replacements. The personal account matters most from 2028: it has no payout cap.

### With the job in 2027*

- **~March:** start setting aside the paycheck + ~25% of payouts
- **~April–May:** open with starter set A (~$11.5k)
- **~Summer:** core 16 pieces (~$26k)
- 2027 contribution ~$5–10k

### Job ends Dec 24

- **~June:** set aside ~25–50% of payouts
- **~July–August:** open with set A
- **~Autumn:** core 16 pieces
- 2027 contribution ~$2–5k

Conditions: the mid-December gate passed, and Apex keeps funding its own slots. If payouts dip, Apex replacements get the money first.

## The capital ladder (1 micro = 1 MNQ / MES / MCL per piece)

| ACCOUNT | SET | $ A YEAR (TYPICAL) | BAD YEAR |
|---|---|---|---|
| ~$11.5k | A: Twin, Overnight Bias ML, Bridge, CL fade, NFP | $8.1k | $3.0k |
| ~$13.6k | C: A + Expiration Short + Vault Break | $10.4k | $4.4k |
| ~$20.4k | D: C + Relative Strength + ES MOC | $14.5k | $6.3k |
| ~$26.2k | **Core: 16 pieces** | $30.5k | $17.0k |
| ~$33.6k | Core + S30 | $36.4k | $20.2k |
| ~$54k | Core × 2 + S30 | $66.8k | $38.2k |
| ~$104k | **Core × 4 + S30 (best mix)** | $127.8k | $72.8k |
| ~$261k | 1 mini per piece | $322.4k | $185.5k |

Sized so a 1-in-20 bad year's drawdown is about 20% of the account. Step up only when the account reaches the row; step down after a 20% drawdown. Live is expected at ≥75% of these.

8 · RISKS

# What could go wrong

| RISK | HOW LIKELY / HOW BIG | WHAT WE DO |
|---|---|---|
| **Nothing funded by Dec 31** | 13–31% of histories; then 2027 can pay $0 without the job | One buy a day; keep the job into 2027 if possible; review if nothing is funded by mid-January |
| **Live edge below backtest** | Expected (~75%); first 3 weeks are below, on few trades | Drift alarm per strategy; mid-December gate; stop buying on an alarm |
| **All accounts are one bet** | Same signals everywhere: a bad month hits every account | Stagger starts; budget for several failures in a row |
| **Evaluation failures** | ~50–60% of evaluations fail, even in the backtest | Treated as the cost of a pass: ~$600 per funded 150K |
| **Operational mistakes** | Already cost one ~$3.2k trade (10/27) | Watchdog, heartbeat, pre-market check, checklists for every new account |
| **Overfitting** | Strategies picked on the data they're scored on | Pre-registration, holdouts, multiple-testing bar, independent checker, forward log |
| **Apex rules or prices change** | Payout caps, consistency rule, account limits can change | Re-check the rules each month; personal account as the long-term home |
| **Execution costs** | Stops fill ~0.8 tick worse than assumed (small sample) | Re-test with 2-tick stops at ~30 fills |
| **Personal finances** | All job pay goes into evaluations | Spend only money you can lose; cover living costs first; taxes not included here |

**What would make us stop**

A drift alarm on a core strategy, live results clearly below 75% of the backtest at the mid-December gate, or nothing funded by mid-January. Any one of these pauses new purchases until the cause is understood.

9 · TIMELINE

# Next steps and decision gates

**SUN NOV 1**
Buy #4 (150K). Set up its 4 charts: account number in every strategy, rejected-orders limit 10, initial position Flat.

**NOV 13 – DEC 24**
3–4 × 150K a week from pay, one a day. Each new account added to the watchdog and dashboard.

**NOV 20**
Options expiration: Expiration Open Short trades.

**NOV 26–27**
Thanksgiving (closed) and half day: strategies use early-close times.

**DEC 10**
MNQ roll: symbol mapping MNQZ6 → MNQH7 after the close.

**MID-DECEMBER · GATE**
~40–70 live trades at ≥75% of the backtest and no drift alarm → keep scaling. Otherwise stop buying and find the cause.

**DEC 31**
Expect ~3–8 funded 150Ks (typical), more in January.

**MID-JANUARY · CHECK**
If nothing is funded: pause and review before spending more.

**LATE FEB – MARCH 2027**
First payouts. Payouts refill slots up to ~20.

**~MARCH – MAY 2027**
Personal account: set money aside, open with starter set A (~$11.5k).

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Sources in the repository: TIER_LIST.md, personal_strategies/PORTFOLIO.md, funded_strategies/FUNDED_PLAN.md, analysis/ramp_budget_test.py, analysis/onb_cushion_test.py, the live dashboard (Apex Live Desk) and live/trades. Version 2 (Oct 24) and version 1 (Oct 16) are kept for comparison.